

▼ TALWAR

Date Early 17th century
Origin India
Weight 1.04kg (2¼lb)
Length 95.7cm (37¾in)

The carved ivory grip is different from the usual iron Indo-Muslim hilts fitted to *talwars*, but is typical of the luxurious tastes of the Mughal court. The early blades, such as this, were slightly less curved than later models.

► DHAL

Date 18th century
Origin India
Weight 2.5kg (5½lb)
Diameter 60cm (23½in)

This domed shield was made of thick rawhide dried in a mould and coated with lacquer to keep the moisture out. The four iron bosses, which secure the handgrips on the inside of the shield, are decorated with gold *koftgari* (inlay work).

◀ KATAR

Date 1760
Origin India
Weight 525g (18½oz)
Length 44.6cm (17½in)

The tip of the curved blade of this dagger is thickened to pierce mail, while the sunken panels have been etched to show the structure of the wootz steel. The *katar* was held by gripping the cross-handles, with the side-bars extending on either side of the wrist.

Solid ends, called *siyahs* in Persian

Velvet hilt pad

Gilded basket hilt

◀ KAMAN

Date 18th century
Origin North India
Weight 550g (19½oz)
Length (Strung) 95cm (37½in)

Mughal bows were made from horn and sinew glued onto a wooden core. Unstrung, they bent the opposite way to when strung. The ends of the limbs were solid, acting as levers to assist in drawing.

Reinforcement decorated with floral pattern

► KHANDA

Date Early 19th century
Origin India
Weight 1.3kg (2¾lb)
Length 93.3cm (36¾in)

The blade of this sword is made of wootz steel, which could only be produced in limited quantities. When hammered out into a sword, it was of necessity rather thin and had to be reinforced to stiffen it. This sword was made for the Great Exhibition of 1851.

► TARKASH AND TIR

Date 18th century
Origin India
Weight 710g (25oz); (Arrow) 18g (¾oz)
Length (Arrow) 73cm (28¾in)

This embroidered velvet quiver (*tarkash*) was worn on the right hip, balanced by a matching bowcase on the left. The painted bamboo arrows (*tir*) were fitted with ivory nocks, three low-cut fletchings, and armour-piercing heads.

Brocade facings

Iron quillon block decorated with gold *koftgari* (inlay work)

Ivory grip carved as a lotus bud

Side-bar

Cross-handles

Religious inscription in gold

Scabbard worn through sash

Thickened mail-piercing blade tip

Wootz steel blade

Fletching

Ivory nock

Grip

Limb

Upturned rim to catch a weapon's point